

Dr Aurélien Frick

Leverhulme Early Career Fellow
 School of Psychology and Neuroscience
 University of St Andrews
 United Kingdom

Email: asaf1@st-andrews.ac.uk

Academic website: <https://aurelienfrick.com>

Academic Appointments

Oct 2026 -
 Sept 2029

Marie Skłodowska-Curie Research Fellow

University of Bristol, United Kingdom, Kyoto University, Japan

Mentors: Prof. Christopher Jarrold (Bristol) and Prof. Satoru Saito (Kyoto)

Role: Principal Investigator of the project “Social Presence Effects Across Cultures through the Lens of Executive Function (SPACE), funded by the European Commission (Horizon Europe). This project examines similarities and differences regarding social presence effects in children from different cultures using behavioural and physiological data. Responsibilities include project leadership, experimental design, international research coordination across the University of Bristol and Kyoto University, supervision of students, advanced statistical and computational analyses, dissemination of findings, and the development of international research collaborations.

Sept 2023-
 Aug 2026

Leverhulme Early Career Research Fellow

University of St Andrews, United Kingdom

Mentor: Prof. Amanda Seed

Role: Principal Investigator of the project “Audience Effects on Children’s Cognitive Control”, funded by the Leverhulme Trust. The project examines how the presence of others modulates the engagement of cognitive control across development, integrating developmental and comparative approaches. Responsibilities include experimental design, project leadership, data collection coordination, statistical analysis, and dissemination of findings.

Feb 2022-
 Sept 2023

Postdoctoral Researcher

University of Liège, Belgium

Supervisors: Dr Christine Bastin et Dr Emma Delhayé

Role: Contributed to a research programme on the neuropsychology of ageing involving MRI data collection with patients and older adults, behavioural and neuroimaging analyses, manuscript preparation, and presentation of findings at international conferences.

²
Nov 2020-
Feb 2022

Career interruption due to COVID-19 pandemic travel restrictions

Recipient of the Shui-Mu Postdoctoral Fellowship at Tsinghua University (China). The fellowship could not be taken up due to international travel restrictions. During this period, remote collaborations were established and the first study on social presence effects on cognitive control was developed with collaborators from Tsinghua University and the University of Tours.

Education

October 2020 PhD in Psychology
University of Edinburgh, United Kingdom
Supervisors: Dr. Nicolas Chevalier and Prof. Maria Brandimonte

Dissertation: « *Understanding autonomous behaviours in children: An investigation of self-directed cognitive control development* »

September 2016 M.A. Cognitive Science
University of Neuchâtel, Switzerland

June 2013 B.A. Psychology
University of Tours, France

Grants

± external funding

±2026 Marie Skłodowska-Curie Postdoctoral Fellowship (MSCA-PF, Global)
European Commission (Horizon Europe)
Principal Investigator (PI)
Budget: ~£360k (36 months)

±2025 JSPS International Fellowship for Research in Japan (Standard) - *declined*
Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (JSPS), Japan
Principal Investigator (PI)
Budget: ~£46k (24 months)

2024 Glasgow Crucible 2024 Seed Funding
University of Glasgow, United Kingdom
Co-Investigator with Dr Dan Fisher et Dr Emma Lawlor
Budget: £2k (12 months)

±2023 Leverhulme Early Career Research Fellowship
Leverhulme Trust, United Kingdom
Principal Investigator (PI)
Budget: ~£92k (36 months)

3 2020	ShuiMu Postdoctoral Fellowship - <i>declined</i> Tsinghua University Principal Investigator (PI) Budget: £70k (24 months)
2017-2019	Research Support Grant University of Edinburgh, United Kingdom Budget: ~£2k (12 months)
2016-2019	PhD Scholarship Suor Orsola Benincasa University, Italy Budget: ~£34k (36 months)

Awards and Recognition

2026	Nominated for the Watson-Arnott Award for Research Excellence (Outstanding Early Career Researcher Category) – University of St Andrews
2026	Recognised as a Top 10 most-cited article published in 2024 in <i>Child Development Perspectives</i> for “You are here! Rethinking children’s executive function in the presence of others.”

Publications

Peer-reviewed journal articles = 20

First-author articles = 13

Co-first author articles = 2

Q1 journals = 19, Q2 journals = 1

*Indicates equal contribution

1. Servais, A., **Frick, A.**, Meyer, F., Bastin, C., & Delhay, E. Familiarity-related processes and the transentorhinal cortex volume: Insights into the cognitive functions of an early site of Alzheimer’s pathology. (in press). *Neuropsychology*.
2. **Frick, A.**, Bouazzaoui, B., Mille, J., Angel, L., Borella, E., Fay, S., Ferrandez, V., Pinard, F., Vanneste, S., & Taconnat, L. Relative contribution of associative memory and working memory to subjective organization in aging. *Memory*, 34(6), 647-655.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/09658211.2026.2655432>
3. **Frick, A.**, McEwen, E. S., Seed, A. M. Chimpanzees’ working memory is not affected by the presence and activity of zoo visitors. (2026). *Animal Cognition*, 29(7).
<https://doi.org/10.1007/s10071-025-02014-4>

4. Chevalier, N., & **Frick, A.** (2025). Neural Oscillatory Markers of Voluntary Task Switching: Proactive Engagement of Self-Directed Control in Children and Adults. *Developmental Science*, 28(6), e70073. <https://doi.org/10.1111/desc.70073>
5. **Frick, A.**, Belletier, C., Tan, W., Ning, M., Zhou, Q., Christie, S.*, & Camos, V*. The effects of an unfamiliar experimenter on proactive and reactive control in children. (2025). *Scientific Reports*, 15(1), 5860. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-025-89193-9>
6. **Frick, A.** You are here! Rethinking children's executive function in the presence of others. (2024). *Child Development Perspectives*, 9(2), 116-125. <https://doi.org/10.1111/cdep.12533>
7. Décaillet, M.*, **Frick, A.***, Lince, X., Gruber, T., & Denervaud, S. (2024). Variation in pedagogy affects overimitation in children and adolescents. *Journal of experimental child psychology*, 241, 105862. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jecp.2024.105862>
8. **Frick, A.**, & Chevalier, N. (2023). A first theoretical model of self-directed cognitive control development. *Journal of Cognition and Development*, 24(2), 191-204. <https://doi.org/10.1080/15248372.2022.2160720>
9. **Frick, A.**, Besson, G., Salmon, E., & Delhay, E. (2023). Perirhinal cortex is associated with fine-grained discrimination of conceptually confusable objects in Alzheimer's disease. *Neurobiology of Aging*, 130, 1-11. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.neurobiolaging.2023.06.003>
10. **Frick, A.**, Fay, S., Bouazzaoui, B., Sauzéon, H., Angel, L., Vanneste, S., & Taconnat, L. (2023). The respective contribution of cognitive control and working memory to semantic and subjective organization in aging. *Psychology and Aging*, 38(5), 455. <https://doi.org/10.1037/pag0000752>
11. Eon Duval, P., **Frick, A.**, & Denervaud, S. (2023). Divergent and Convergent Thinking across the Schoolyears: A Dynamic Perspective on Creativity Development. *Journal of Creative Behavior*, 57(2), 186-198. <https://doi.org/10.1002/jocb.569>
12. **Frick, A.**, Wright, H. R., Fay, S., Vanneste, S., Angel, L., Bouazzaoui, B., & Taconnat, L. (2022). The protective effect of educational level varies as a function of the difficulty of the memory task in ageing. *European Journal of Ageing*, 1-9. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10433-022-00724-z>
13. **Frick, A.**, Wright, H. R., Witt, A., & Taconnat, L. The underlying processes of episodic memory development: From a unique contribution of representation to the increasing use of semantic organization supported by cognitive control. *Cognitive Development*, 63, 101217. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cogdev.2022.101217>
14. **Frick, A.**, Brandimonte, M. A., & Chevalier, N. (2022). Understanding autonomous behaviour in children: Exploring the contributions of context-tracking and task selection to self-directed control development. *Developmental Science*, 25(4), e13222. <https://doi.org/10.1111/desc.13222>
15. **Frick, A.***, Schleihau, H.*, Satchell, L. P., & Gruber, T. (2021). Carry-over effects of tool functionality and previous unsuccessfulness increase overimitation in children. *Royal Society Open Science*, 8, 201373. <https://doi.org/10.1098/rsos.201373>

16. **Frick, A.**, Brandimonte, M. A., & Chevalier, N. (2020). Disentangling the respective contribution of task selection and task execution to self-directed cognitive control development. *Child Development*, 92(4), 1309-1324. <https://doi.org/10.1111/cdev.13479>
17. **Frick, A.**, Brandimonte, M. A., & Chevalier, N. (2019). Voluntary task switching in children: Switching more reduces the cost of task selection. *Developmental Psychology*, 55(8), 1615–1625. <https://doi.org/10.1037/dev0000757>
18. Gruber, T., **Frick, A.**, Hirata, S., Adachi, I., & Biro, D. (2019). Spontaneous categorization of tools based on observation in children and chimpanzees. *Scientific Reports*, 9(1), 1-12. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-019-54345-1>
19. Gruber, T., Deschenaux, A., **Frick, A.**, & Clément, F. (2019) Group membership influences more social identification than social learning or overimitation in children. *Child Development*, 90(3), 728-745. <https://doi.org/10.1111/cdev.12931>
20. **Frick, A.**, Clément, F., & Gruber, T. (2017). Evidence for a sex effect during overimitation: boys copy irrelevant modelled actions more than girls across cultures. *Royal Society Open Science*, 4(12), 170367. <https://doi.org/10.1098/rsos.170367>

Invited Talks

June 2026	University of Portsmouth, United Kingdom
January 2026	Université of St Andrews, United Kingdom
June 2025	University of Clermont-Auvergne, France
October 2020	University of Tours, France
June 2020	Tsinghua University, China

Conference Presentation (excluding posters)

October 2025	Scottish Primate Research Group Meeting Ezell, United Kingdom
September 2024	BPS Developmental Psychology Section Annual Conference 2024 Glasgow, United Kingdom
March 2023	2 nd Edition of the Recollection, Novelty and Familiarity Conference Liège, Belgium
August 2022	22 nd Edition of the European Society for Cognitive Psychology Lille, France

6
May 2020

Culture Conference 2021
Stirling, United Kingdom

August 2017

7th European Federation for Primatology Meeting
Strasbourg, France

Academic Service

Conference organisation

March 2023

2nd Edition of the Recollection, Novelty and Familiarity Conference
Liège, Belgium

Peer reviewer

- Journal articles (n = 29): *Journal of Experimental Child Psychology* (5), *Behavioural Brain Research* (3), *Behavioral Research Methods* (2), *Developmental Science* (2), *Journal of Comparative Psychology* (2), *Cognition* (1), *Developmental Review* (2), *Journal of Cognition and Development* (1), *Psychology and Aging* (2), *Quarterly Journal of Experimental Psychology* (2), *Social Development* (1), *Memory & Cognition* (1), *Acta Psychology* (1), *Humanities & Social Sciences Communications* (1), *Journal of Cognition* (1).
- Grants (n = 1): Agence National de la Recherche (France)

Teaching and Supervision

Teaching

2026

Guest Lecturer (1 Lecture + Practical), BSc in Psychology, Developmental Psychology (PN3033)
University of St Andrews, United Kingdom

2024

Guest Lecturer (2 lectures), MSc Developmental Science, Developmental Science 1 (PSYL11103)
University of Edinburgh, United Kingdom

2024

Guest Lecturer (2 lectures) BSc in Psychology, Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience Childhood (PSYL10135)
University of Edinburgh, United Kingdom

2023

Guest Lecturer (2 lecture), BSc in Psychology, Cognitive Development: Theoretical and Clinical Approaches (PSYC5860-1)
University of Liège, Belgium

2018

Tutor, BSc in Psychology, Introduction to Psychology
University of Edinburgh, United Kingdom

Supervision

2025 Undergraduate dissertation co-supervised (with Prof. Amanda Seed): Rhian
Leverage, Jacob Yule, Angela Goodall
University of St Andrews, United Kingdom

References

Dr Nicolas Chevalier, University of Edinburgh

Prof. Amanda Seed, University of St Andrews

Prof. Christopher Jarrold, University of Bristol

Prof. Valérie Camos, University of Fribourg

Prof. Laurence Taconnat, University of Tours